

Welcome: start here

This pack has what you need for the first week: an alphabet chart, a vowel-marks card, and Unit 1 (the first six letters).

1 Print

- A4 paper, portrait, "actual size". Black and white is fine.
- Pencils (HB) and a rubber for the child. A soft pencil is easier to trace with.

2 Sit down

- 10 minutes, once a day. Stop while the child still wants more.
- Sit on the child's left so your hand does not hide the page.

3 Remember three things

- Urdu goes **right to left**. Start on the right of the page.
- Letters **join**, and change shape. The chart shows all the shapes.
- **Body first, dots last**. Write the whole word, then add the dots.

4 What is inside

1. Alphabet chart in teaching order (2 pages)
2. Vowel marks card
3. Unit 1: guide, trace sheets for the six letters, look-alikes, join the letters, read and match, reading practice, unit check, answer keys

More sheets for every unit are in the app, under Practice sheets.



Alphabet chart: the order we teach

حروفِ تہجی

39 letters. Each card: the letter alone, then its shape at the start, middle and end of a word (read from the right).

1 alif الف 'a' in father when long ا ا end	2 be بے 'b' in bat ب ب ب ب end middle start	3 kāf کاف 'k' in kite ک ک ک ک end middle start
4 lām لام 'l' in log ل ل ل ل end middle start	5 mīm میم 'm' in mat م م م م end middle start	6 nūn نون 'n' in net ن ن ن ن end middle start
7 te تے soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth (Spanis...) ت ت ت ت end middle start	8 choṭī ye چھوٹی بے 'y' in yes at the start ی ی ی ی end middle start	9 baṛī ye بڑی بے 'ay' in day ے ے end
10 pe پے 'p' in pat پ پ پ پ end middle start	11 ṭe ٹے hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled back ٹ ٹ ٹ ٹ end middle start	12 ṣe ٹے 's' in sun (Arabic loanwords only) ث ث ث ث end middle start
13 wā'o واؤ 'w'/'v' at the start و و end	14 re رے tapped 'r' (Spanish 'pero') ر ر end	15 dāl دال soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth د د end
16 choṭī he (gol he) بے / گول بے 'h' in hat ہ ہ ہ ہ end middle start	17 sīn سین 's' in sun س س س س end middle start	18 shīn شین 'sh' in shop ش ش ش ش end middle start
19 jīm جیم 'j' in jam ج ج ج ج end middle start	20 che چے 'ch' in chair چ چ چ چ end middle start	21 gāf گاف 'g' in go گ گ گ گ end middle start

Alphabet chart: the order we teach

حروفِ تہجی

39 letters. Each card: the letter alone, then its shape at the start, middle and end of a word (read from the right).

22 nūn ghunna نون غنہ nasalises the vowel before it, like French... ن ن end	23 do-chashmī he دو چشمی ہے a puff of breath after the letter before it: ہ... ہ ہ ہ ہ end middle start	24 ḍāl ڈال hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled... ڈ ڈ end
25 ṛe رے a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue... ر ر end	26 ze زے 'z' in zoo ز ز end	27 zhe ژے 's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare) ژ ژ end
28 fe فے 'f' in fat ف ف ف ف end middle start	29 qāf قاف a 'k' made far back in the throat (Arabic...) ق ق ق ق end middle start	30 khe خے 'ch' in Scottish loch خ خ خ خ end middle start
31 ghain غین a gargled 'g', like the French 'r' غ غ غ غ end middle start	32 ‘ain عین in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel... ع ع ع ع end middle start	33 baṛī ḥe بڑی ہے 'h' in hat (Arabic loanwords) ح ح ح ح end middle start
34 ṣwād صاد 's' in sun ص ص ص ص end middle start	35 ẓwād ضاد 'z' in zoo ض ض ض ض end middle start	36 ṭo'e طوے soft 't' ط ط ط ط end middle start
37 ẓo'e ظوے 'z' in zoo ظ ظ ظ ظ end middle start	38 zāl زال 'z' in zoo ز ز end	39 hamza ہمزہ a tiny break between two vowels (کوئی ko-...) ئ ئ ئ ئ end middle start

Vowel marks and signs

حرکات

The small marks are written above or below a letter. They tell you the short vowel. We keep them in every word until unit 11.

بَ zabar زیر short a (as in 'but') بَسْ bas · enough	بِ zer زیر short i (as in 'bit') دِل dil · heart	بُ pesh پیش short u (as in 'put') گُل gul · flower
بْ jazm (sukūn) جزم no vowel after this letter سَبْزِی sabzī · vegetable	بّ tashdīd تشدید double the letter بچّہ bachcha · child	اَبَ khaṛā zabar کھڑا زیر long ā without alif اَعْلٰی a'lā · high

+ Long vowels

Letter	Sound	Example	Reads as
ا	ā	کام	kām
آ	ā (word start)	آم	ām
ی	ī	تین	tīn
و	ū	جوتا	jūtā
و	o	روٹی	roṭī
ے	e	لے	le
ے	ai	ہے	hai
و	au	اور	aur
ی	ai (mid-word)	میں	main

+ Numbers

۹	۸	۷	۶	۵	۴	۳	۲	۱	۰
9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1	0

+ Signs

۔ full stop · , comma · ؟ question mark · ؛ semicolon

Unit 1: The first six

پہلے چھ حرف

1 In this unit

Joiners vs the non-joiner alif; alif as long ā; the three short-vowel marks zabar, zer, pesh.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.



2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ا	alif الف 'a' in father when long	one stroke, top to bottom	lām
ب	be بے 'b' in bat	start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last	nūn
ک	kāf کاف 'k' in kite	base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top	none yet
ل	lām لام 'l' in log	tall stroke down, curve into the bowl	alif
م	mīm میم 'm' in mat	small loop, tail down-left	none yet
ن	nūn نون 'n' in net	deep round bowl; dot last	be

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write:** one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes:** circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters:** standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match:** word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice:** words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation:** the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check:** 10 questions, answer key on the last page of that sheet (at the end of the pack).

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise effort:** "you started on the right", "good dots". One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time's letters, the child says them. 5 min the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. 3 min read it back together and end on something done well.

Trace and write: alif

Name _____ Date _____

alif الف

Sound: 'a' in father when long

the body only: no dots

How the pen moves: one stroke, top to bottom.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone



Again, alone



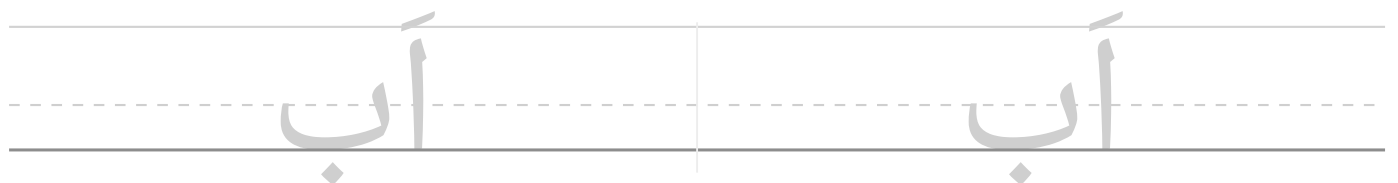
End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)



From memory: write it alone



In a word: ab (now)



Trace and write: be

بے

Name _____ Date _____

be بے

Sound: 'b' in bat

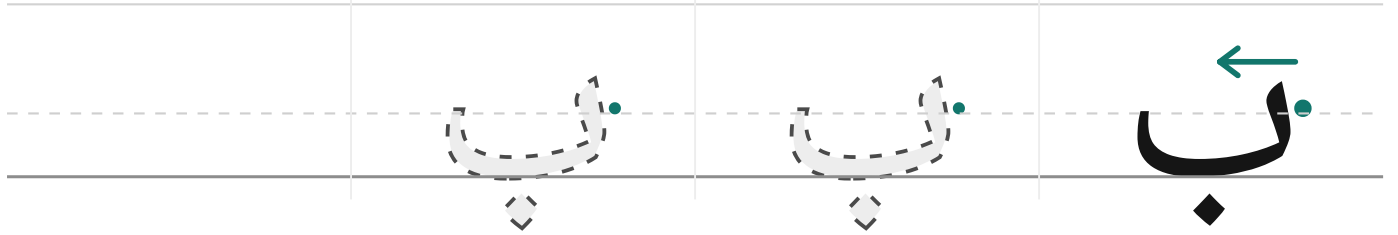
step 1: the body

step 2: 1 dot

How the pen moves: start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

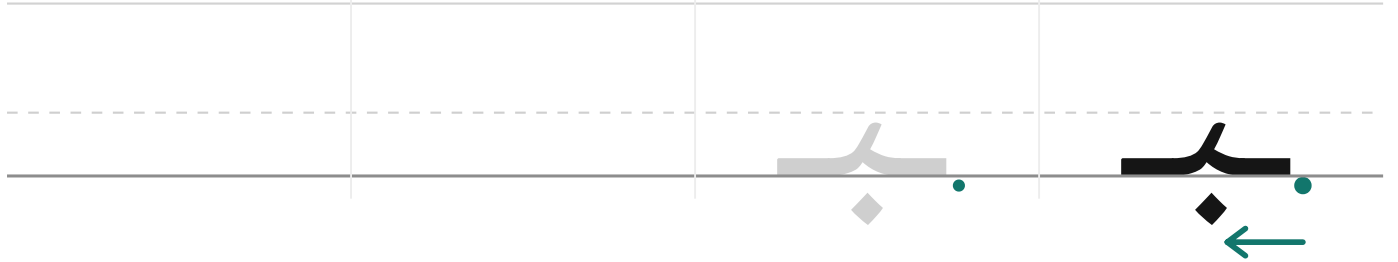
Alone



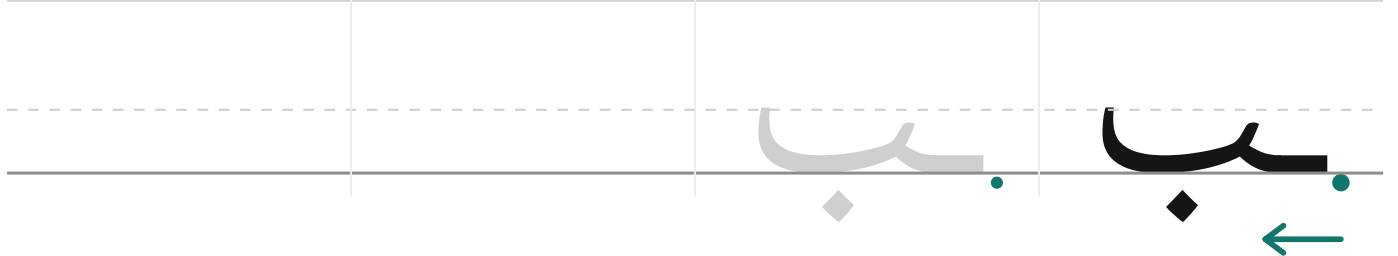
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



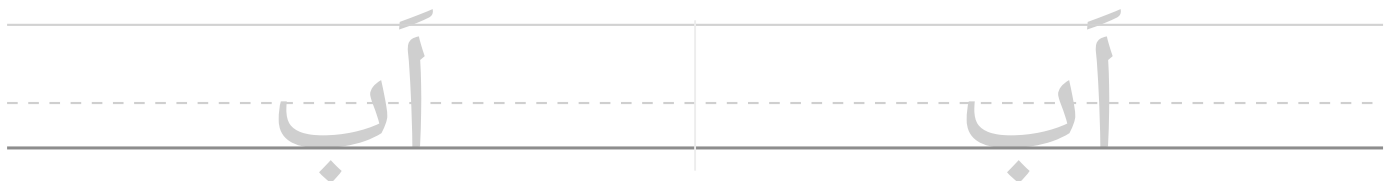
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: ab (now)



Trace and write: kāf

Name _____ Date _____

kāf کاف

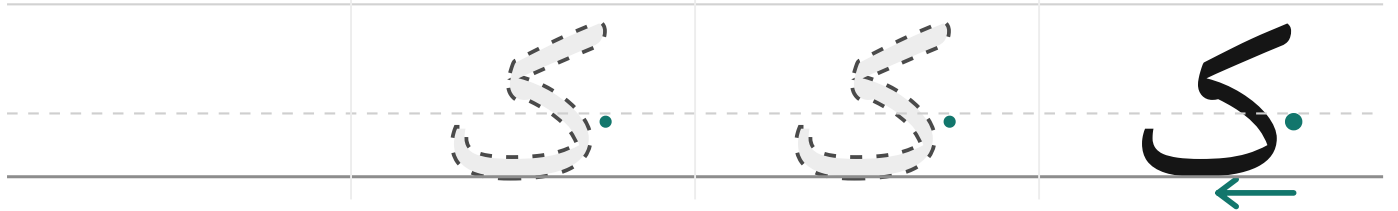
Sound: 'k' in kite

the body only: no dots

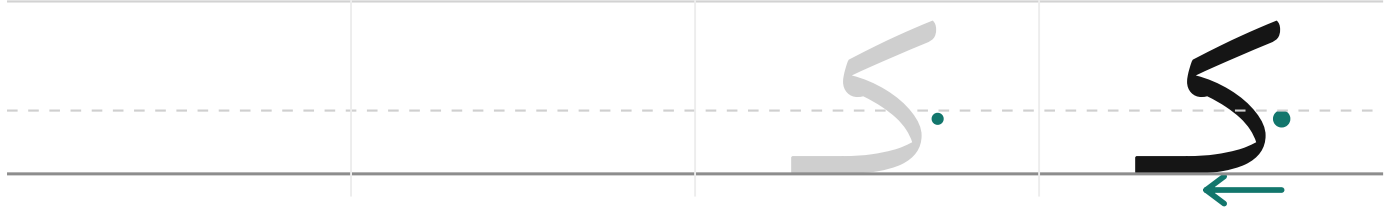
How the pen moves: base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

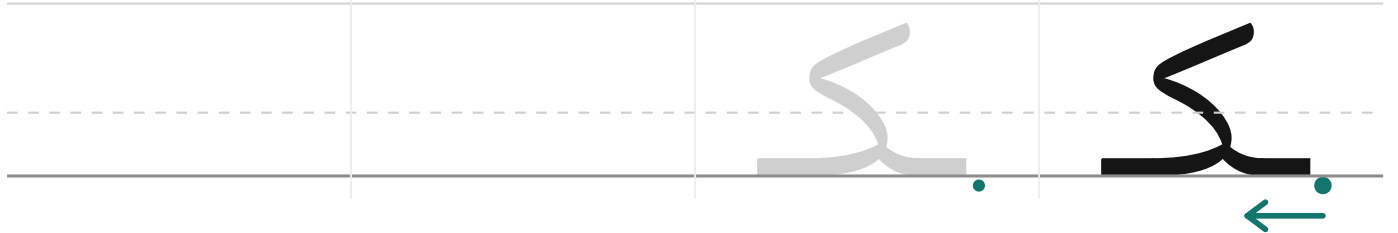
Alone



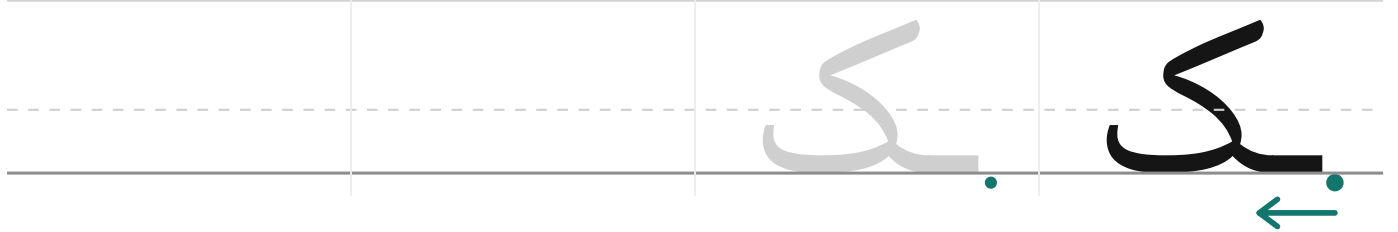
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kam (few, less)



Trace and write: lām

لام

Name _____ Date _____

lām لام

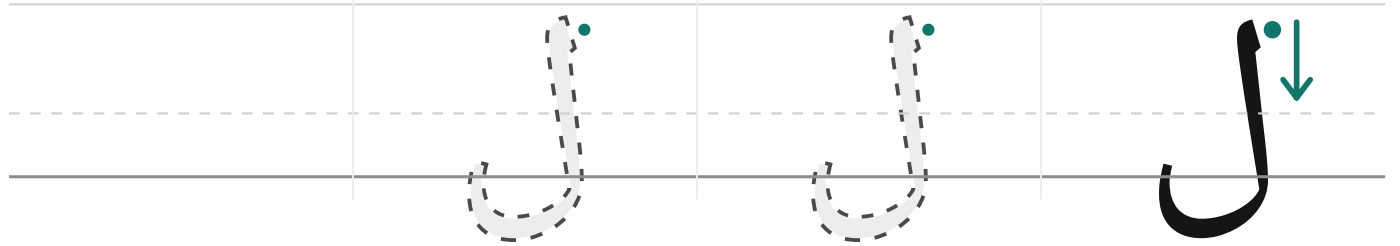
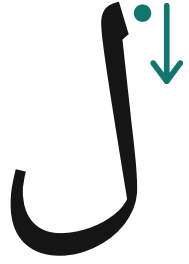
Sound: 'l' in log

the body only: no dots

How the pen moves: tall stroke down, curve into the bowl.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

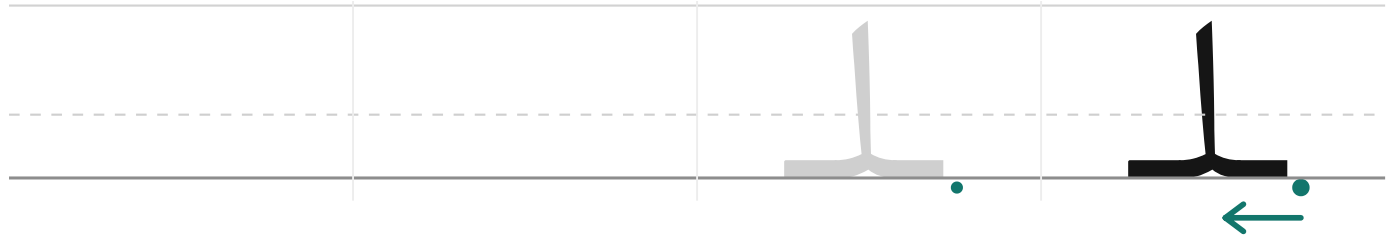
Alone



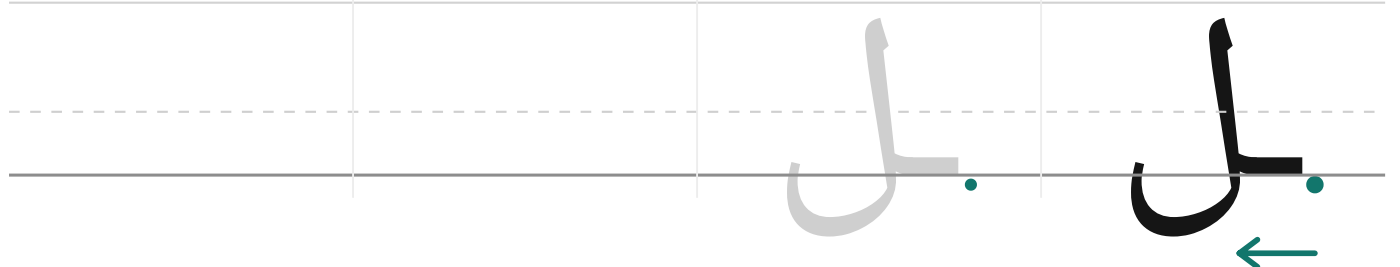
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



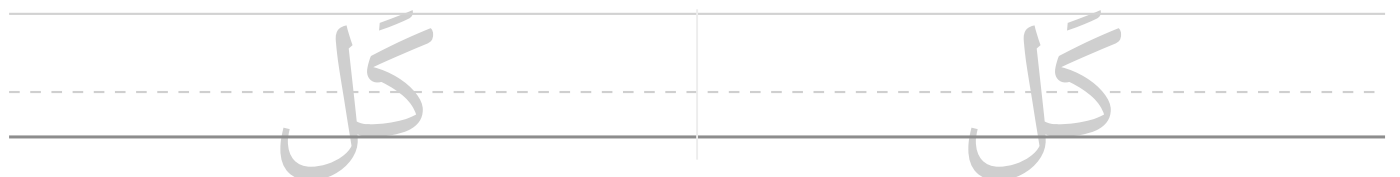
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kal (tomorrow, yesterday)



Trace and write: mīm

میم

Name _____ Date _____

mīm میم

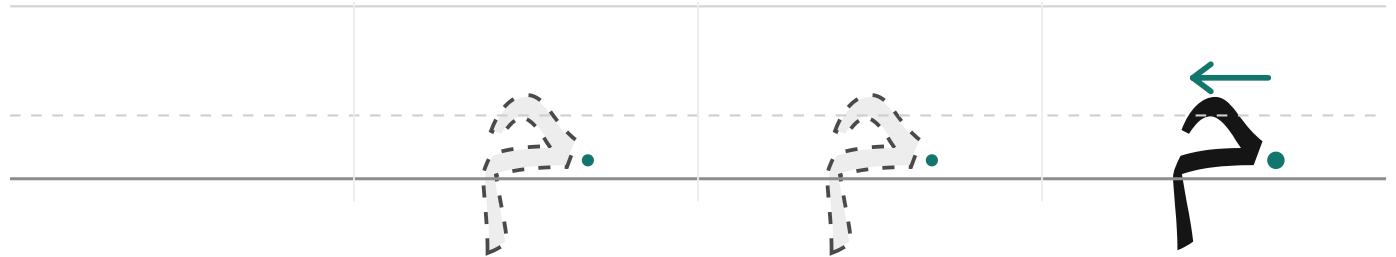
Sound: 'm' in mat

the body only: no dots

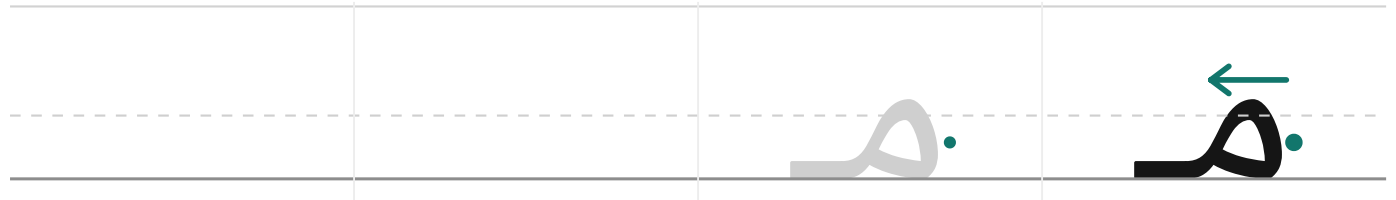
How the pen moves: small loop, tail down-left.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

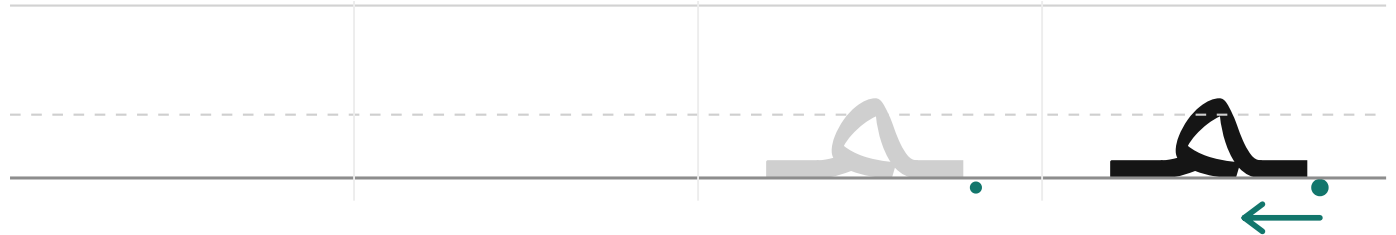
Alone



Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



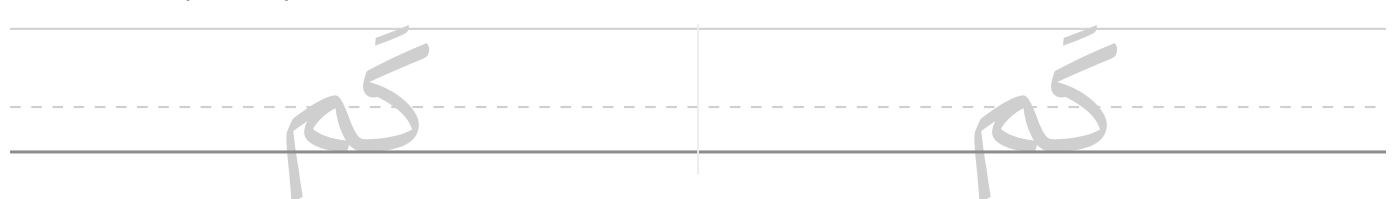
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kam (few, less)



Trace and write: nūn

نون

Name _____ Date _____

nūn نون

Sound: 'n' in net

step 1: the body

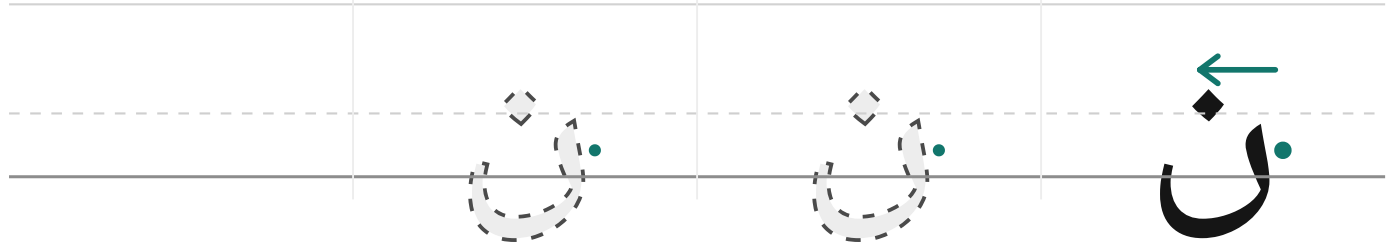
step 2: 1 dot

How the pen moves: deep round bowl; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone

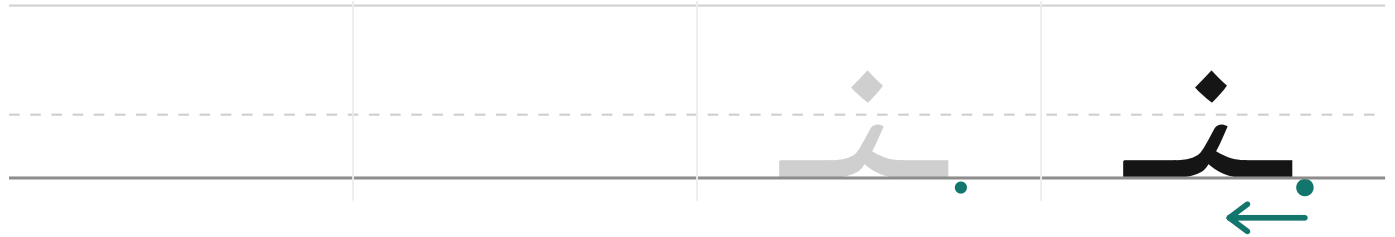
نون



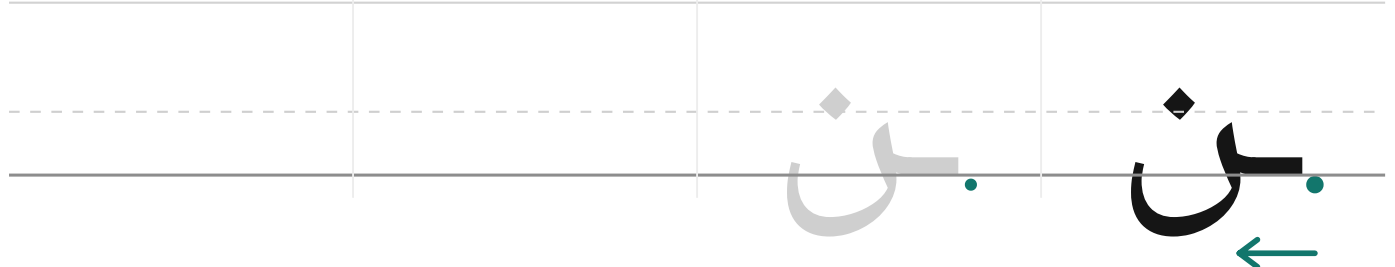
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



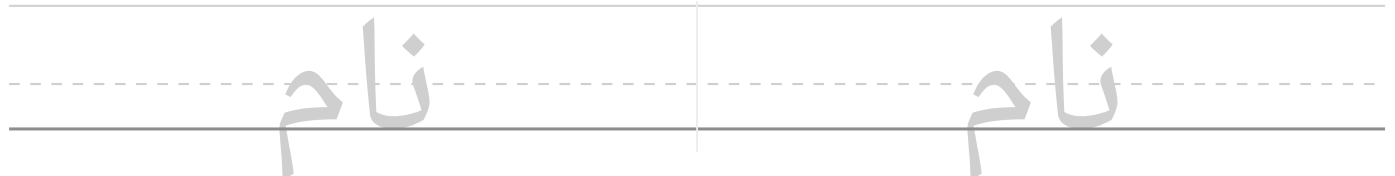
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: nām (name)



Look-alike letters

ملتے جلتے حرف

Name _____ Date _____

1 Circle every letter that is the same as the big one on the right.

ا	ن	ا	ل	ا	م	ک	ا
ک	ب	ب	ل	ب	ن	ا	ب
ک	ک	ل	ا	ک	ن	م	ک
ل	ک	ا	ب	ل	ن	م	ل
م	م	ل	ا	ک	ن	ب	م
ب	ن	ل	ن	ک	ا	ن	ن

2 Count the dots on each letter. Write the letter again in the box with that many dots.

ل	ب	ک	م	ن	ا
---	---	---	---	---	---

No dots

1 dot

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

1

بِ ا ل كُ ل

Say: bilkul (absolutely)

بِ ا ل كُ ل

2

م ا ل ك

Say: mālik (owner)

م ا ل ك

3

ل ا ب م

Say: lambā (long, tall)

4

ا م ك ا ن

Say: imkān (possibility)

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

5

گ + ل + ا + م

Say: kalām (speech, words)

کلام

6

گ + م + ا + ل

Say: kamāl (perfection, skill)

کمال

7

ن + ا + ک + ا + م

Say: nākām (unsuccessful)

8

ن + ا + م + م + ک + ن

Say: nāmumkin (impossible)

Read and match

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each Urdu word. Draw a line to its meaning.

a unsuccessful

b impossible

c owner

d house

e perfect

f speech, words

g long, tall

h absolutely

i perfection, skill

j possibility

بِالْكُلِّ 1

مَالِك 2

لَفْظًا 3

إِمْكَان 4

گَلام 5

گَمَال 6

نَاکَام 7

نَامُمْكِن 8

کَامِل 9

مَکَان 10

Read and match

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each Urdu word. Draw a line to its meaning.

a to meet

b met, got

c name

d country

e to take out

f to earn

g work

h bow

i blanket

j to mix, join

نِکالنا

11

گھمان

12

مِلنا

13

گمبَل

14

مِلانا

15

گھمانا

16

کام

17

نام

18

مُلک

19

مِلا

20

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).

إِمْكَان

○ ○ ○

لَمْبَا

○ ○ ○

مَالِك

○ ○ ○

بِالْكُلِّ

○ ○ ○

نَامُمْكِن

○ ○ ○

نَاكَام

○ ○ ○

كَامَال

○ ○ ○

كَامَلَام

○ ○ ○

كَامَان

○ ○ ○

نِكَالْنَا

○ ○ ○

مَكَان

○ ○ ○

كَامِل

○ ○ ○

كَامَانَا

○ ○ ○

مِلَانَا

○ ○ ○

كَامْبَل

○ ○ ○

مِلْنَا

○ ○ ○

مِلَا

○ ○ ○

مُلْك

○ ○ ○

نَام

○ ○ ○

كَام

○ ○ ○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bilkul (absolutely) · mālīk (owner) · lambā (long, tall) · imkān (possibility) · kalām (speech, words) · kamāl (perfection, skill) · nākām (unsuccessful) · nāmumkin (impossible) · kāmīl (perfect) · makān (house) · nikālānā (to take out) · kamān (bow) · milnā (to meet) · kambal (blanket) · milānā (to mix, join) · kamānā (to earn) · kām (work) · nām (name) · mulk (country) · milā (met, got)

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).

مُمْكِن

○ ○ ○

مُكَمَّل

○ ○ ○

بِنَا

○ ○ ○

بَال

○ ○ ○

كَالَا

○ ○ ○

نَاك

○ ○ ○

بَنَانَا

○ ○ ○

مَال

○ ○ ○

مَانُنَا

○ ○ ○

نَمَك

○ ○ ○

كَان

○ ○ ○

مَان

○ ○ ○

كَبَاب

○ ○ ○

إِمْلَا

○ ○ ○

مَالَا

○ ○ ○

لَانَا

○ ○ ○

أَب

○ ○ ○

كَم

○ ○ ○

مَنَانَا

○ ○ ○

مُنَّا

○ ○ ○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bāl (hair) · binā (without) · mukammal (complete) · mumkin (possible) · māl (goods, wealth) · banānā (to make) · nāk (nose) · kālā (black) · māl (pride, honour) · kār (ear) · namak (salt) · mānnā (to accept, obey) · lānā (to bring) · mālā (garland) · imlā (spelling) · kabāb (kebab) · munnā (dear little boy) · manānā (to persuade, celebrate) · kam (few, less) · ab (now)

Read the sentences

جملے پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

2 Read each line twice. Slide your finger under the words, right to left. Then trace it.

○ ○

بابا کا نام گمال

بابا کا نام گمال

○ ○

نانا کا مکان

نانا کا مکان

○ ○

کالا گمبل لانا

کالا گمبل لانا

3 Read the story. Ask: who? where? what happened?

گمال کا بابا۔ گمال کا نانا۔ نانا کا مکان لمبا۔ نانا کا گمبل کالا۔ گمال کا کام:
نمک لانا۔

Time it: ____ seconds. Words in the story: 19. Words per minute = $19 \times 60 \div \text{seconds}$.

For the grown-up: sounds and meanings

Read the lines aloud first, then let the child read them. Ask the three questions after the story.

1. bābā kā nām kamāl - dad's name is Kamal

2. nānā kā makān - grandfather's house

3. kālā kambal lānā - bring the black blanket

Story. kamāl kā bābā. kamāl kā nānā. nānā kā makān lambā. nānā kā kambal kālā. kamāl kā kām: namak lānā.

Meaning. Kamal's dad. Kamal's grandfather. Grandfather's house is long. Grandfather's blanket is black.
Kamal's job: bringing salt.

Unit 1 check

Name _____ Date _____

A grown-up reads each prompt. No help with the letters. 10 questions, about 10 minutes.

1 Say: "be" ('b' in bat)



2 Say: "kāf" ('k' in kite)



3 Say: "lām" ('l' in log)



4 How many dots does this letter have?



5 Say: "kal" (tomorrow, yesterday)



6 Say: "milānā" (to mix, join)



7 Say: "māl" (goods, wealth)



8 Join the letters and write the word. Say: "nāk".



9 Join the letters and write the word. Say: "lambā".



10 Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلَا

☐ right ☐ needs help

Score: _____ / 10

8 or more: ready for the next unit

Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

+ Look-alike letters, part 1: circle these (counting from the right)

Letter	Circles
ا	3, 5, 7
ب	3, 5, 6
ک	3, 6, 7
ل	3, 7
م	6, 7
ن	1, 4, 6

+ Look-alike letters, part 2: the dot boxes

Box	Letters
no dots	ا م ک ل
1 dot	ن ب

+ Read and match: which meaning goes with each word

1 → h	2 → c	3 → g	4 → j	5 → f	6 → i	7 → a	8 → b	9 → e	10 → d
11 → e	12 → h	13 → a	14 → i	15 → j	16 → f	17 → g	18 → c	19 → d	
20 → b									

Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

+ Join the letters: the words

#	Word	Say / meaning
1	بِالْكُلِّ	bilkul (absolutely)
2	مَالِك	mālik (owner)
3	لَمْبَا	lambā (long, tall)
4	إِمْكَان	imkān (possibility)
5	كَالَام	kalām (speech, words)
6	كَمَال	kamāl (perfection, skill)
7	نَاكَام	nākām (unsuccessful)
8	نَاْمُمْكِن	nāmumkin (impossible)

Unit 1 check: answer key

Correct answers are circled. If the score is under 8: redo the look-alike sheet and the trace sheet for the letters that were missed, wait a day, try again.

- 1** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter
Say: "be" ('b' in bat)



- 2** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter
Say: "kāf" ('k' in kite)



- 3** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter
Say: "lām" ('l' in log)



- 4** If wrong, redo: look-alike sheet, part 2
How many dots does this letter have?



- 5** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice
Say: "kal" (tomorrow, yesterday)



- 6** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice
Say: "milānā" (to mix, join)



- 7** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice
Say: "māl" (goods, wealth)



- 8** If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet
Join the letters and write the word. Say: "nāk".



ناک

- 9** If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet
Join the letters and write the word. Say: "lambā".



لمبا

- 10** If wrong, redo: reading practice words
Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلا

Answer: milā (met, got)